

Nandhini Natarajan

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[Website](#) | [ORCID](#) | [LinkedIn](#)

I am a doctoral researcher at the Centre of Excellence in Music, Mind, Body and Brain at the University of Jyväskylä in Finland. In my PhD, I am examining the role of the somatosensory state in the music listening experience using MEG. I am broadly interested in studying the neural correlates and mechanisms of music-based interventions using (M)EEG and fMRI.

EDUCATION

University of Jyväskylä, Jyväskylä, Finland

Musicology (PhD)

November 2022 - Present

Supervisor: Dr. Esa Ala-Ruona

Project: Good Vibrations: The Role of the Somatosensory State in the Music Listening Experience

Expected Completion: June 2027

Teachers College, Columbia University, New York, USA

Neuroscience and Education (M.S.)

September 2020 - May 2022

Thesis: A Case for the Use of Music-Based Interventions to Alleviate Symptoms of Depression: Evidence from Neuroscientific Studies

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Centre of Excellence in Music, Mind, Body and Brain, University of Jyväskylä

Doctoral Researcher

November 2022 - Present

Developmental Affective Neuroscience Lab, Columbia University, New York

Research Assistant

June 2021 - July 2022

Shigemoto Lab, Institute of Science and Technology (IST) Austria, Vienna, Austria

Scientific Intern

June 2019 - June 2020

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Neuroimaging Acquisition:** (M)EEG
- **Data Analysis:** MNE-Python, CONN, Linear mixed effects modelling
- **Qualitative methods:** Thematic analysis, Content analysis
- **Software:** PsychoPy, REDCap

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

- Semi-finalist in the FORTHEM Researcher's Grand Prix (2026)
- CNSP Travel Award sponsored by mBrainTrain (2024)
- Spring 2021 Program Scholarship from the Neuroscience and Education program at Teachers College, Columbia University (2021)
- OeAD scholarship for the 'ISTernship' program at IST Austria (2019)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

The Effects of Vibroacoustic Stimulation on the Music Listening Experience: An MEG Study
Federation of European Neuroscience Societies Forum 2026 (Spain), Poster

An Exploration of the Effect of Vibroacoustic Stimulation on the Music Listening Experience:
An MEG Study
Annual Conference of Cognitive Science 2025 (India), Poster

The Effect of Vibroacoustic Stimulation on Relaxation during Music Listening in Healthy
Adults
*Triennial Conference of the European Society for the Cognitive Sciences of Music (ESCOM) 2025
(Online)*, Poster

Exploring Music Making in Everyday Lives through a Grounded Theory Study
International Conference of Students of Systematic Musicology (SysMus) 2025 (Online), Poster

The Effect of Vibroacoustic Stimulation on Relaxation during Music Listening in Healthy
Adults
The Future of Music and Arts in Medicine and Health conference 2024 (Berlin), Poster

Face the Music: Piloting an EEG Study on Clinical Improvisation
International Conference of Students of Systematic Musicology (SysMus) 2024 (Jyväskylä), Oral

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Lecturer, University of Jyväskylä, Finland
Music and Neuroscience
September 2024 - December 2024, September 2025 - December 2025

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Columbia University, New York
Cellular and Molecular Neurobiology II: Development and Systems
January 2022 - May 2022

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Barnard College, Columbia University, New York
Systems and Behavioral Neuroscience
January 2022 - May 2022

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Columbia University, New York
Cellular and Molecular Neurobiology I
September 2021 - December 2021

SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

- Organizing Chair of SysMus 2024 at the University of Jyväskylä
- Served on the scientific committee for SysMus 2024, SysMus 2025 and Musiconnex 2026
- Member of the SysMus Council (2024–present)